

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X  
RASHAUN MITCHELL,

Plaintiff,

-against-

**SUMMONS**

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE OFFICER  
ANTHONY CRUPI, Shield No. 6111, and POLICE  
OFFICER JOHN DOES NUMBERS ONE THROUGH  
TEN,

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:  
Location of Incident

Defendants.

Plaintiff designates Kings  
County as the place of trial.

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**To the above named Defendants:**

**You are hereby summoned** to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York  
May 11, 2020

Yours, etc.



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CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.  
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC  
Attorney for Plaintiff  
30 Broad Street Suite 702  
New York, New York 10004  
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NYPD POLICE OFFICER ANTHONY CRUPI, Shield No. 6111, NYPD, PSA 1, 2860  
West 23<sup>rd</sup> Street, Brooklyn, NY 11224

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF KINGS

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RASHAUN MITCHELL,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE OFFICER  
ANTHONY CRUPI, Shield No. 6111, and POLICE  
OFFICER JOHN DOES NUMBERS ONE THROUGH  
TEN,

Defendants.  
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**INDEX NO.:**

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

**JURY TRIAL DEMANDED**

Plaintiff RASHAUN MITCHELL, by his attorneys, Caitlin Robin & Associates, PLLC,  
as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

**PRELIMINARY STATEMENT**

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On January 4, 2020, at approximately 5:00 p.m., Plaintiff RASHAUN MITCHELL, while lawfully in the vicinity of 21 Mill Street, Brooklyn, New York, was subject to an unlawful search, false arrest, and false imprisonment by the defendant New York City police officers. Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted and denied the right to due process and a fair trial until all charges against Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed in their entirety on or about January 5, 2020. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional and common law rights when the individual defendants unlawfully searched, confined, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, maliciously prosecuted, and denied Plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

**PARTIES**

2. Plaintiff RASHAUN MITCHELL is a resident of the state of New York.

3. NYPD POLICE OFFICER ANTHONY CRUPI, Shield No. 6111, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

4. NYPD POLICE OFFICER ANTHONY CRUPI, Shield No. 6111, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the NYPD 70<sup>th</sup> Precinct.

5. NYPD POLICE OFFICER ANTHONY CRUPI, Shield No. 6111, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

6. New York City Police Officers John Does #1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

7. Police Officer John Does Does #1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

8. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

9. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a Police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

10. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

11. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on April 30, 2020.

12. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

13. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

14. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

### **STATEMENT OF FACTS**

15. On January 4, 2020, at approximately 5:00 p.m., Plaintiff was lawfully present in the vicinity of 21 Mill Street, Brooklyn, New York, when the defendant police officers unlawfully handcuffed and falsely arrested Plaintiff without probable cause, or any legal justification.

16. Plaintiff went grocery shopping with his female friend, Teroya Huntley, and bought about \$400 worth of groceries.

17. Plaintiff dropped his friend and the groceries off at her house, and planned to park and watch the NFL playoffs.

18. After Plaintiff dropped his friend off in the car, he was stopped by Defendant Officers.

19. At no time prior to being stopped by the Defendant Officers, did Plaintiff commit any VTL infractions.

20. Defendant Officers asked Plaintiff for his license, registration, and insurance, which Plaintiff handed over.

21. Plaintiff's license, registration, and insurance, were all valid.

22. Defendant Officer then told Plaintiff the car, "smells like weed."

23. Plaintiff told the Defendant Officer, "that's impossible, I don't smoke."

24. Defendant Officer then asked for permission to search the vehicle, which Plaintiff consented to.

25. No contraband or anything illegal was found in the vehicle.

26. Defendant Officers then told Plaintiff, "You have a warrant, we are arresting you, put your hands behind your back."

27. Plaintiff works for the City of New York and told Defendant Officer, "That's impossible. My job would know if I had any open warrants or criminal cases. Could you please double check? You have my license."

28. The Defendant Officers refused to double check the warrants and illegally handcuffed Plaintiff.

29. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officer have an objective reason to accuse Plaintiff of committing a crime or violating the law in any way, nor did Plaintiff have any open warrants.

30. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and handcuffed by defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause.

31. At no point in time did Plaintiff resist arrest in any way.

32. Plaintiff was searched, and no contraband or anything illegal was found on him.

33. Plaintiff was transported to the 76<sup>th</sup> Precinct for processing.

34. At the 76<sup>th</sup> Precinct, Defendant Officers asked Plaintiff for his name, date of birth, and social security number, which Plaintiff provided.

35. Plaintiff kept asking the Officers, "What is the name and date of birth on the alleged warrant?"

36. Defendant Officers refused to tell Plaintiff anything about the warrants.

37. Plaintiff was then transported to Kings County Central Bookings.

38. The defendant police officers provided the District Attorney's Office with the false, misleading and/or incomplete information that Plaintiff committed a crime.

39. At central booking, Plaintiff was given a free public defender lawyer, Dan Kisselstein.

40. Mr. Kisselstein showed Plaintiff copies of the alleged warrants, which had a different name, a different date of birth, and a different social security number.

41. On January 5, 2020, after approximately 24 hours in unlawful custody, Plaintiff was arraigned in Kings County Criminal Court, and charged with crimes that the defendant officers had no basis to alleged that he committed.

42. Mr. Kisselstein showed the Judge the warrants that did not pertain to Mr. Mitchell but were used by the Defendant Officers to support his arrest.

43. Judge Rao agreed with Mr. Kisselstein that the warrants could not possibly be Mr. Mitchell, since it was a different name, date of birth, and social security number.

44. On or about January 5, 2020, all charges against Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed against.

45. As a result of the arrest, Plaintiff missed one day of work at his job for the City of New York.

46. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably searching, seizing, falsely arresting and imprisoning, denying the right to due process and a fair trial, and maliciously prosecuting of Plaintiff.

47. The unlawful, search, seizure, false arrest and imprisonment, denial of the right to a fair trial, and malicious prosecution of Plaintiff by the individually named defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

### **FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights**

48. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 47 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

49. The individually named police officer defendants while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

50. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, psychological and economic injuries.

### **SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **False Arrest and False Imprisonment**

51. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 50 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

52. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In

addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

53. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

54. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

55. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

56. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

### **THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Unlawful Search**

57. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 56 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

58. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

59. Defendants lacked probable cause to search Plaintiff.

60. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

61. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

62. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

63. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

### **FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Violation of Plaintiff's Fifth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights**

### **Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process**

64. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 63 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

65. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

66. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

67. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

68. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff RASHAUN MITCHELL, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

69. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff RASHAUN MITCHELL, sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, lost earnings and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

70. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

71. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

72. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

### **FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress**

73. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 72 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.



74. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to plaintiff, RASHAUN MITCHEL. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

75. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

76. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

77. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

78. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

79. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

### **SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision**

80. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 79 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

81. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

82. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

### **SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

#### **Failure to Intervene**

83. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 82 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

84. The defendants that did not physically touch plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

85. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

86. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

87. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

88. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

89. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

90. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

## **EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

### **Malicious Prosecution**

91. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 90 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

92. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the laws of the United States Constitution, State of New York and New York State common law.

93. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against Plaintiff.

94. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiff and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.

95. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

96. Plaintiff was subjected to a post-arraignment deprivation of liberty sufficient to implicate Plaintiff's Fourth Amendment rights.

97. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

98. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

99. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

#### **JURY DEMAND**

100. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

#### **PRAYER FOR RELIEF**

**WHEREFORE**, Plaintiff RASHAUN MITCHELL demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York  
May 11, 2020

By:   
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.  
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC  
Attorney for Plaintiff  
30 Broad Street Suite 702  
New York, New York 10004  
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

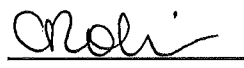
NYPD POLICE OFFICER ANTHONY CRUPI, Shield No. 6111, NYPD, PSA 1, 2860  
West 23<sup>rd</sup> Street, Brooklyn, NY 11224

**ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION**

**CAITLIN ROBIN**, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a member of the law firm of **CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York  
May 11, 2020

  
\_\_\_\_\_  
CAITLIN ROBIN